

Google product deaths

iGoogle, Google Video, Google Mini and a couple other projects of Google meet their demise. <http://dgit.in/LPNNbe>

**Beta ways to communicate**

In the latest beta release of Chrome, it is possible for you to grant web apps access to your camera and microphone right within the browser. <http://dgit.in/McQaTl>

Yahoo falls prey to hackers; over 400,000 account credentials leaked

Yahoo Inc. has said that it is investigating reports of a security breach that saw nearly half a million users' e-mail addresses and passwords leaked out on the Internet. The company, however, confirmed the compromised user information belongs to Yahoo Voices services, previously known as Associated Content. Hackers belonging to a group called 'D33Ds Company' have claimed responsibility of the security breach.

Yahoo said that only less than 5 percent of Voice accounts had still-valid passwords, but the leak of file had revealed e-mail addresses of hundreds of thousands of its users. In an emailed statement, Yahoo further said that it is working to fix the vul-

nerability that had caused the security breach. The company also assured of changing victim users' passwords and notifying companies with accounts that might have been compromised.

"We apologize to affected users. We encourage users to change their passwords on a regular basis and also familiarize themselves with our online safety

tips at security.yahoo.com," read the Yahoo statement.

Hackers group D33Ds Company posted a text file with the leaked information online and revealed that they had applied union-based SQL injection to breach the data. "We hope that the parties responsible for managing the security of this subdomain will take this as a wake-up call, and not as a

threat," D33Ds said in a message accompanying the leaked data.

"There have been many security holes exploited in Web servers belonging to Yahoo! Inc. that have caused far greater damage than our disclosure. Please do not take them lightly. The subdomain and vulnerable parameters have not been posted to avoid further damage."

Meanwhile, *The New York Times* in its report says that the more than 400,000 usernames

and passwords that have leaked included log-in information for mail, Hotmail, Comcast, MSN, Verizon, AOL, SBC Global and Live.com accounts. According to the U.S.-based Security Firm Rapid 7, the information features 106,000 Gmail account credentials.

"The most alarming part of the entire story was the fact that the passwords were stored entirely unencrypted," the security firm said in its blog. 



LinkedIn starts rolling out 'simpler' home page design

LinkedIn has announced a redesign of its home page in order to make it look cleaner and easier to use. The professional networking site is also working to make the navigation process simpler and add a richer update stream.

LinkedIn, in a blog post says the redesigned homepage will make it easier to scan and find the information a user is looking for. Also, the simpler and cleaner design makes it easier to navigate the page.

Moreover, users can now see the important and relevant news updates on the top of the feed. This is supposed to make it easy for users to go through trending topics, news and professional updates, based on your connections and industries you are associated with. LinkedIn says this will reduce time spent on hunting for information on the website.



LinkedIn's redesigned home page

LinkedIn has also dropped Twitter integration, with the their three-year partnership ending in July. Earlier, LinkedIn users could link their accounts to Twitter, with messages posted to Twitter automatically showing up on the LinkedIn news feed. That will no longer be the case. 

Microsoft acquires Yammer for \$1.2 bn

As expected, Microsoft has officially acquired enterprise social network Yammer for \$1.2 billion. Yammer will join the Microsoft Office division, led by Kurt DelBene, and the Yammer team will continue to report to current CEO David Sacks, Microsoft said in a statement.

"The acquisition of Yammer underscores our commitment to deliver technology that

businesses need and people love," said Steve Ballmer, CEO of Microsoft. "Yammer adds a best-in-class enterprise social networking service to Microsoft's growing portfolio of complementary cloud services."

Microsoft said Yammer will continue to develop as a standalone service. Going forward, Microsoft will incorporate Yammer into offerings like SharePoint, Office 365, Microsoft Dynamics, and Skype. 